



Program Monitoring, Evaluation, Learning and Impact Assessment (MELIA) Plan

Policy Innovations Program

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1. Program/Accelerator overview and results framework

Program/Accelerator overview

Policies and institutions are powerful determinants of development outcomes. Sound policies, implemented via increasingly capable institutions, can create virtuous circles of positive impact. All CGIAR Science Programs and Accelerators engage with policy issues, but the Science Program on Policy Innovations (Policy Program) is unique in that it focuses on the transformation of food, land, and water (FLW) Systems as a whole. This systems-wide approach mirrors a fundamental challenge confronting high-level policymakers: they must simultaneously address multiple issues in the context of interrelated and ongoing (mega) trends while pursuing multiple objectives.

In collaboration with partners, the Policy Program identifies portfolios of policies, investments, and innovations that address all five Impact Areas. This Program's high-level research questions are fundamentally integrative. Examples include: what combinations of policies, institutions, and technologies are most effective in enabling FLW system actors to contribute to inclusive, equitable, and sustainable transformation of food systems and economies? How can governance structures be enhanced to reduce the impacts of external shocks, improve accountabilities, minimize elite capture, enhance equitable outcomes, and strengthen the provision of environmental benefits? What sets of spatially targeted investments maximize synergies and minimize trade-offs across the Water-Energy-Food-Ecosystem (WEFE) nexus?

The Policy Program envisions “policies and institutions for FLW systems that drive rapid, inclusive transformation, fostering futures where people and planet thrive”. This vision is operationalized via six Areas of Work (AoWs). Foresight and prioritization (AoW1) charts potential future development pathways and identifies cost-effective policy and investment packages that address inevitable tradeoffs across competing objectives. Market-led transformation (AoW2) identifies appropriate technological and institutional innovations, supportive policies, and innovative ways to harness the power of markets to drive positive transformation. Governance and political economy (AoW3) recognizes that political economy barriers and governance failures can prevent the operationalization of good policy ideas and seeks to propose feasible paths forward. WEFE Nexus policy (AoW4) navigates policy trade-offs and synergies across the WEFE nexus. Country and regional strategy and engagement (AoW5) leverages on-the-ground policy programs with key national institutions to respond to demand for policy support and supply evidence-based recommendations into policy processes. The global poverty and jobs hub (AoW6) advances integration within and beyond the Policy Program and maintains a pro-poor focus.

Facilitating positive policy impact is often the result of a delicate mix of consistent and agile research

and policy engagement. Consistency and perseverance build capability and trust, which are crucial for engaging partners and affecting policy reforms. Agility recognizes that major policy reforms often occur in relatively short time windows and that providing key inputs at the right moment in the process is often crucial for achieving impact. The Policy Program constitutes a unique package of activities that combines (i) consistent, high-quality, collaborative research that enhances capabilities and deepens trust with policy partners at multiple levels of decision-making and (ii) agile response to policy demand at high leverage moments. Ultimately, the Policy Program aims to facilitate more deliberate and evidence-based decision-making and posits that this will lead to better decisions, delivering strong positive impact simultaneously across all five impact areas.

Components

A core challenge faced by high-level policymakers is the need to address multiple issues simultaneously, all within the context of interconnected and evolving megatrends—while also pursuing diverse and often competing objectives. The Policy Program reflects this complexity by taking a systems-level approach to transforming food, land, and water systems.

What sets the Policy Program apart from other One CGIAR Initiatives is its integrative structure: it brings several key Areas of Work (AoWs) together under one umbrella. Specifically:

- Under Foresight and Prioritization, it delivers advanced ex ante analytics;
- Under Market-led Transformation, it conducts rigorous ex post evaluations; and
- Under Governance and Political Economy, it explores questions of feasibility and implementation capacity using leading-edge policy and institutional analysis.

Together, these three AoWs address the core questions that drive policy formation:

1. What will happen if...?
2. What has happened?
3. Can it be done?

In addition, two further AoWs apply these approaches within specific contexts. One focuses on the water-energy-food-environment nexus across selected geographies. The other builds on CGIAR's long-standing relationships with policymaking institutions in 15 countries—offering a unique, embedded approach to national policy engagement.

Finally, a coordination-focused AoW supports cross-cutting collaboration. It enables:

- Joint studies across CGIAR Science Programs,
- Capacity sharing among initiatives, and
- Multi-stakeholder policy platforms.

Theory of change

The Policy Program posits that evidence-based decisions will lead to superior outcomes in this complex context. In collaboration with other Programs and Accelerators, it seeks to identify sound policies, investments, and innovations to improve nutrition, reduce poverty, improve equity, halt biodiversity loss, improve environmental quality, adapt to climate change, and move rapidly to net zero greenhouse gas emissions.

Based on the ISDC comments- in particular the limited coordination and collaboration across AoWs- and internal discussions, the Program is now organised along three pillars used by all AoWs: agenda setting, rapid response and policy guidance, and capacity & tools. .

The Program's Theory of Change works through six interconnected Areas of Work (AoWs), their High-level Outputs (HLOs), leading to Intermediate Outcomes and finally to three 2030 Outcomes.

During the inception phase the Policy Program aligned the Intermediate Outcomes and 2030 Outcomes to these 3 pillars. The 2030 Outcomes were revised to contribute to our impact around these. **2030 Outcome 1: National think tanks analytical and institutional capacity strengthened to guide policy and investment decisions considering trade-offs between SDGs:** represents the Capacity and tools pillar, **2030 Outcome 2: Global, regional institutions and governments use knowledge products on foresight, impact assessment and governance to guide pro-poor, gender-inclusive and climate smart policies and investments,** represents Rapid Response and policy guidance pillar while **2030 Outcome 3: Governments and partners adopt policy responses to address local, national, regional and global challenges and shocks, contributing to more coherent and sustainable development processes that deliver positive outcomes across a range of SDG targets,** contributes to Agenda setting for our partners through research outputs. These Outcomes contribute to all of CGIAR Impact Areas, though the emphasis is on i) nutrition, health and food security; ii) poverty reduction, livelihoods and jobs; iii) climate adaptation and mitigation and iv) gender equality, Youth and social inclusion and to SDGs 1 (No Poverty), 8 (Decent Work and Economic Growth) and 10 (Reduced Inequalities).

The progress towards the 2030 Outcomes is operationalized via six AoWs, contributing to 11 Intermediate outcomes which consolidate outputs from the 20 High-level outputs of the Policy Program. All Intermediate Outcomes contribute towards the 2030 Outcomes. For example, Intermediate outcomes 1.2.1 (Partners use outlook reports to inform and enhance design of their strategies and policies), 4.2.1 (Partners achieve a shared understanding of emerging challenges in WEFE systems and foresight data, tools and analysis), 5.2.1 (Countries co-create national strategies and policies) and 6.2.2 (CGIAR researchers and partners have enhanced capacity) all address the capacity challenge and contribute to the impact pathway achieving 2030 Outcome 1: National think tanks analytical and institutional capacity strengthened to guide policy and investment decisions considering trade-offs between SDGs. This 2030 Outcome in turn, also addresses CGIAR Portfolio Outcome #1: Implementation partners (e.g. NARES, NGOs, private companies) actively support

dissemination, uptake and implementation of CGIAR innovations, Outcome #3: Research institutions, government analytical units, and scaling partners in the Global South have improved knowledge, skills, access to data, capacity to develop tools, innovations, and undertake research to support transformation of food, land and water systems contributing to livelihood, inclusion, nutrition, environmental and climate objectives. And Portfolio Outcome #5: National and local multistakeholder platforms are strengthened to become more effective and sustainable, addressing development trade-offs and generating strategies for effective food, land and water systems transformations. These Portfolio Outcomes via the 2030 Outcome will inform CGIAR Impact Areas on Poverty Reduction, Livelihoods, and Jobs as well as that on Gender equality, Youth and Social Inclusion. This impact pathway leads to SGD8.

Intermediate Outcomes 1.2.2 (Partners use foresight analysis to enhance investment decisions, prioritize policy reform and respond to crisis), 2.2.1 (FLW system actors get guidance to sustainable transform food systems), 3.2.1 (Partners and key constituencies adopt tools and modalities for uptake of politically feasible and coherent policies), 4.2.2 (Systems-level interactions in FLW systems are better understood and addressed), 4.2.3 (Decision makers support advancing women's empowerment and gender equality), and 5.2.2 (Policymakers have access to and adopt evidence-based policy solutions) contribute towards achieving 2030 Outcome 2 on Global, regional institutions and governments use knowledge products on foresight, impact assessment and governance to guide pro-poor, gender-inclusive and climate smart policies and investments. This Outcome is mapped to CGIAR Portfolio Outcomes #3: Research institutions, government analytical units, and scaling partners in the Global South have improved knowledge, skills, access to data, capacity to develop tools, innovations, and undertake research to support transformation of food, land and water systems contributing to livelihood, inclusion, nutrition, environmental and climate objectives and Portfolio Outcome #4: National and sub-national government agencies use CGIAR research results to design or implement strategies, policies and programs which have the potential to transform food, land and water systems contributing to livelihood, inclusion, nutrition, environmental and climate resilience objectives. These are in turn mapped to the CGIAR Impact Areas on Poverty Reduction, livelihoods and jobs and that on Climate Adaptation and Mitigation. This Impact Pathways informs SDG 1: No Poverty and SDG 10: Reduced Inequalities.

Similarly, and not surprisingly, the agenda setting work of the Policy Program is mostly coming from AoWs like Aow 4 and 5 which work at the national and regional level with national governments and regional institutions, supported by AoW2 and 3 with their global research portfolio. The cross-cutting work across these pillars is embedded in AoW 6 for poverty reduction and jobs but also have presence in the work of AoW4 and AoW5. This also highlight how tools and analysis done within AoWs 1, 2 and 3 are being used to drive evidence-based policies at the country level. 2030 Outcome 3: Governments and partners adopt policy responses to address local, national, regional and global challenges and shocks, contributing to more coherent and sustainable development processes that deliver positive outcomes across a range of SDG targets is mapped to Intermediate Outcome 3.2.1: Partners and key constituencies adopt analytical tools, institutional modalities, and modes of engagement for uptake of politically feasible, coherent policies that strengthen sustainable,

equitable food, land and water system governance, I-OC 4.2.2: Systems-level interactions in food, land and water systems are better understood and addressed through policies, investments and institutions, I-OC 4.2.3: Decision makers support and advance pro poor and gender inclusive policies and investments. In AoW 5, I-OC 5.2.1: Countries co-create national strategies and policies, and institutions benefit from capacity sharing in the implementation of policy and program activities and I-OC 5.2.2: Policy makers at national and regional levels have access to and adopt evidence-based policy decisions. In the Global Poverty and Policy knowledge Brokering Hub, AoW6, agenda setting is mapped to I-OC 6.2.1: Policy makers at national and regional level have access to and adopt evidence-based policy solutions on poverty and inequality reduction as well as decent employment to improve livelihoods. 2030 Outcome 3 of the Policy Program embodies the bulk of the work done within the policy program and therefore also maps into CGIAR Portfolio Outcome #3: Research institutions, government analytical units, and scaling partners in the Global South have improved knowledge, skills, access to data, capacity to develop tools, innovations, and undertake research to support transformation of food, land and water systems contributing to livelihood, inclusion, nutrition, environmental and climate objectives and Portfolio Outcome #4: National and sub-national government agencies use CGIAR research results to design or implement strategies, policies and programs which have the potential to transform food, land and water systems contributing to livelihood, inclusion, nutrition, environmental and climate resilience objectives. Not surprisingly, This Outcome also maps to most of the CG Impact Areas of Nutrition, health and Food Security, Poverty Reduction, Gender Equality, and Environmental health.

Assumptions drive the Intermediate and 2030 Outcomes. The key assumptions for the Policy Program are: 1) Partners are willing to use Program data and tools; 2) partners' priorities are relatively constant (data and tools remain relevant to partners; 3) trade-offs are sufficiently acknowledged by partners; 4) Scaling mechanism to reach FLW system actors, governments and decision makers available; 5) Ability and willingness to engage; and 6) political willingness to use a system approach. Together they define the premise on the success of the program.

The Theory of Change was substantially adjusted during the inception period. Focused discussions within and across AoWs were organized to create clarity on how the Policy Program seeks to deliver impact across scale. Concurrently, AoW-level ToCs were revised to streamline and consolidate High-Level Outputs (HLOs), and their intermediate outcomes. This refinement was facilitated by identifying and consolidating overlapping activities and HLOs, enabling a more cohesive approach. Several AoWs reduced the number of HLOs and intermediate outcomes by identifying such overlap and redundancies. The impact pathways of HLOs to Intermediate Outcomes and then to the 2030 Outcomes were clarified responding to ISDC comments. Similarly, the cross-cutting work was firmed up to show synergy across AoW HLOs.

During the Inception phase, key exercises such as co-design, partnerships, and prioritization underscored the demand-driven nature of the policy program. Research agendas are co-developed at the country-level with national policy institutions and governments, ensuring alignment with country priorities and enhancing capacity for research uptake. This country-level codesign process

enabled developing of a country-level TOC detailing how their work aligns and supports the 3pillars of the Policy Program. The country ToC development process is elaborated in the section on Co-design and partnerships. In the short time frame of the Inception period, Malawi and Kenya was completed, but Pakistan and Nigeria are in the process while other focus countries will also be done within the year. This approach is supported by the global focus of Areas of Work (AoWs), which addressed issues like market dynamics, governance, and political economy, transcending national boundaries.

ToC diagrams

The ToC framework is available at: <https://toc.mel.cgiar.org/toc/ad4b441a-8d53-4e9f-b789-5f7d32eff0a1?relatedFlowId=40259386-62bf-420b-9b7f-6041bdd4e9a1>

Results framework

The Policy Program results framework is available at : [toc.mel.cgiar.org.xlsx](https://toc.mel.cgiar.org/toc/ad4b441a-8d53-4e9f-b789-5f7d32eff0a1?relatedFlowId=40259386-62bf-420b-9b7f-6041bdd4e9a1)

1. Monitoring plan for HLOs and outcomes

This section outlines how the Policy Program will monitor delivery of HLOs and progress towards outcomes. For tracking progress, the high-level outputs (HLOs) and intermediate outcomes, are each supported by specific activities detailed in the Program of Work and Budget (POWB). This framework serves as the foundation for monitoring progress, ensuring not only the implementation of activities but also the validation of underlying assumptions to achieve the anticipated changes. Targets were developed consultatively within the AoWs but also corroborated at the Program level since this determines the overall targets committed for the 2030 Outcomes.

Data collection strategy

The Results Framework details the HLOs, Intermediate Outcomes and 2030 Outcomes they contribute to for each AoW.

Data flow from the stakeholders and at the activity level to monitoring the achievement of outputs and intermediate outcomes will be collected by AoW MELIA point-persons at schedules mentioned in the PRMS. For outputs produced by AoW teams, like reports, papers and policy seminars and workshops, these will be entered regularly in the PROB and POWB by the AoW MELIA point person after completion of the activities. For workshops and events jointly organized with other AoWs, P/As and external partners, data will be entered once the activity is completed to comply with completion deadlines. Information collected from stakeholders will be collected quarterly through meetings and interviews as well as focus groups.

The raw data will be entered into the POWB and will be mapped to the AoW point person leading the activity. Primary responsibility of data quality check will rest on this person to make sure that the outcomes of the activities are correctly represented. The collective data from activity leads will be compiled by AoW-level MELIA person. The Policy Program is setting up a MELIA team of AoW-level MELIA representatives reporting results which will be compiled at the AoW level. AoW leads will check the data and match the outputs with the activities and will provide narrative and evidence about achievements at the Intermediate outcome level. This will include demand for CGIAR research from stakeholders and partners like the NARES and government and also evidence of use of CGIAR research by stakeholders and partners. All data from the AoWs will be compiled and cross-checked by the MELIA Lead.

The PRMS systems will be used to monitor the HLOs and Intermediate Outcomes and manage reporting for the Program. The POWB will monitor the HLOs and ensure that targets are met by the deadline. Most of the HLO indicators are quantitative and will be collected at the AoW level by the AoW MEL team. Attainment of higher-level outcomes like policy change or adoption of best practices will be monitored both at the AoW as well as the Program level and has mostly qualitative indicators to best understand the process. Quantitative indicators are also assigned to Intermediate outcomes, so that information can be better triangulated. For the Policy Program a host of methods will be used for collecting data. However, Altmetrics, reports and Website statistics seem to be the

most frequently used for collecting data on HLOs. Focus groups seem to be a recurring method used by most AoWs to collect data around adoption and policy engagement concurring with the greater qualitative nature of such information. A lot of data also comes from regular meetings with partners and thus will be gathered continuously, but the annual cycle will be followed for most other data collection.

Data collected also needs to be verified to maintain quality control and reference relevant documentation for evidence. The PRMS system will be used currently to store and maintain the data collected. Reported HLOs and Intermediate Outcomes from AoWs will be quality checked through the internal review process within AoWs before reporting to the PRMS system. Data repositories will be created and maintained at the AoW level to ensure evidence preservation.

Data and reporting on HLOs from bilaterals will be checked by Center delegates for the Program for quality assurance. Data will be cross-checked and validated at the Program level during reporting period.

The Program MELIA lead will work closely with the AoW MEL focal points and the AoW leads to monitor progress, verify data and compiling information for reporting. Each result will be evidenced with supporting documentation and justifications. It will also be cross-checked to ensure accuracy. To ensure data collected is both accurate and of good quality several measures will be put in place:

- a) Spot checks will be conducted of a data segment to see if it matches with the POWB and is based on activities conducted.

- b) Randomly data from AoWs will be verified by contacting the activity lead to match the entry with the activity concept note. This will also be a necessary step as a lot of activities have been revised and/or deleted following budget cuts.

- c) Data quality assurance measures will be put in place to ensure that data entered is free from errors and is accurate and narratives clearly define outcomes achieved. Also cross-checking narrative with evidence submitted to ensure that there is accuracy.

2. Evaluation plan

Evaluation studies

Several MELIA studies have been scheduled to validate assumptions and Intermediate Outcomes within the AoWs and further to 2030 Outcomes.

In 2025, evaluation and learning studies that started under the Initiatives will be finalized. These have been listed in Annex 2 and included in the AOW PORB. Two studies initiated during the Inception phase—the Gendered Soil Health Assessment in Uganda and the Uzbekistan Irrigation Technology Subsidy Assessment—will be completed by 2027. The Uganda study will inform the 2030 Outcome related to the impact of capacity strengthening on national policies, while the Uzbekistan study will assess the intermediate outcome of AoW4 concerning the Food, Land, and Water systems nexus.

As this is the start of the Program, evaluation studies have not started or been designed. Most of the evaluation and MELIA studies are scheduled for the latter part of the program as implementation progresses, and evidence becomes more accessible.

The MELIA studies planned cover a wide range from qualitative studies to quantitative and impact assessment studies.

A comprehensive list of Monitoring, Evaluation, Learning, and Impact Assessment (MELIA) studies is provided in Annex 2.

Evaluation collaboration plans

The policy program collaborates with the scaling for Impact and GESI accelerators. The Policy Program contributes by analyzing the enabling policy environments that support or constrain scaling, identifying bundled socio-technical innovations most likely to succeed in specific contexts, and articulating the economy-wide returns to scaling investments. These contributions are structured under Areas of Work 1, 2, and 3. For example, the Policy Program evaluates potential unintended consequences of sector-specific scaling efforts and proposes coherent policy and investment portfolios that support inclusive and sustainable impact. The Policy Program maintains an active and evolving partnership with the GESI to ensure that inclusivity and equity are central to policy analysis and recommendations.

The Gendered Soil Health Assessment in Uganda and the Uzbekistan Irrigation Technology Subsidy Assessment will be conducted in collaboration with GESI and SPIA.

3. Impact assessment

Program/Accelerator impact overview

During the inception phase, the Policy Program's 2030 Outcomes were revised to better align with its three main pillars: rapid policy response, policy agenda setting, and capacity development for partners. This alignment ensures a more focused approach across all impact pathways.

Additionally, the High-Level Outcomes (HLOs) and intermediate outcomes were updated to correspond with the 2030 Outcomes, enhancing coherence between Areas of Work (AoWs) and the broader CGIAR portfolio.

The primary impact pathways within the Policy Program are Research and Knowledge Advancement and Government Policy, which correspond to the three pillars defined during the inception phase. For instance, tools and innovations developed by AoWs 1 through 4 are supported by on-demand, policy-oriented research at both global and national levels. These outputs are utilized by policymakers to inform policy incorporation. This policy change process is driven by research and is co-developed with partners, rather than being handed down as a research output. During the inception phase, each AoW team scrutinized their Theories of Change (ToCs) to explicitly elicit these capacity-sharing mechanisms through the HLOs and intermediate outcomes.

The Policy Program has also identified several cross-cutting areas, such as jobs, youth, and poverty. While AoW 6 primarily serves as the poverty and jobs brokering hub, other AoWs actively participate in these areas. One of the interactions that will be further explored is the feedback loops connecting various intermediate outcomes and how these outcomes may be interlinked, which has implications for the impact on the 2030 Outcomes.

Assumptions are central to the ToC, and the Policy Program is no exception. Recurring assumptions in the ToC revolve around empowering actors and creating improved knowledge and building capacity to empower these actors. This theme is at the heart of the Policy Program's operations, encompassing concepts such as co-creation and demand-driven research that build capacity and create the right conditions for policy change to occur.

IA activities and collaboration plans

The Impact Assessment (IA) strategy employs a combination of quantitative (both experimental and non-experimental) and qualitative (outcome evidencing) research methods to substantiate the Program's contributions to CGIAR's Impact Areas. Additionally, rapid impact assessment methods are utilized when necessary to track achievements and support swift policy responses. Aligned with the learning objectives of the Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning (MEL) component, the IA strategy provides empirical evidence on the Program's effects, aiming to understand the causal mechanisms underlying both expected and unanticipated outcomes.

Each of the 2030 outcomes is associated with an impact assessment study designed to evaluate the impact of the Policy Program's Theory of Change (ToC). Several Areas of Work (AoWs) have planned IA studies that explore the impact pathways between intermediate outcomes and the 2030 outcomes. Additionally, some impact evaluations are planned to test the validity of the research questions underpinning the Policy Program. The specific research questions addressed and the exact nature of each study (quantitative, qualitative, or mixed methods) are currently under consideration.

While IA studies assess the achievements of the Policy Program, their objective is not to internally evaluate the Program's work. These studies are conducted in collaboration with other programs and

accelerators and involve partners during the implementation process. The MELIA studies planned already list Scaling for Impact and Gender Equality and Social Inclusion (GESI) as collaborators in several IA studies, which are conducted under the guidance of the Standing Panel on Impact Assessment (SPIA)

IA studies

Several impact assessment studies are also planned. These include evaluations testing assumptions between intermediate outcomes and 2030 Outcomes, as well as studies examining the impact of CGIAR evidence on policy decisions at national, regional, and international levels. Assessments of institutional capacity sharing and trade-offs across impact areas are cross-cutting themes that span multiple AoWs and P/As, necessitating coordination at the CGIAR level to assess impact.

4. Learning and adaptive management

The Policy Program team will document, share, and make use of lessons learned for continuous improvement. Adaptive management will be based on both operational process-related learning, making use of lessons as they arise, and research-based learning, making use of lessons in a periodic reflective process that focuses on revisiting the Program ToC.

Learning

Learning is integral to the Policy Program. Encouraging learning within and across AoWs and across Programs/Areas (P/As) is a priority. The MELIA framework is designed to systematically capture and integrate learning outcomes from program activities. While it provides a structured approach to assess and enhance program effectiveness, the Policy program's strategic focus on ten countries with strong country presence necessitates a more dynamic and context-responsive learning process. In these settings, learning is often continuous and embedded within the program's operations, aligning with adaptive management principles that emphasize real-time adjustments based on ongoing feedback and situational changes.

This adaptive approach contrasts with traditional models that rely on periodic learning events. Instead, it fosters an environment where learning is an integral part of daily operations, enabling the program to remain responsive and effective in diverse and evolving contexts. To facilitate this process the country ToCs are being developed and the Program is in the process of synergizing AoW outputs in these focus countries. This approach ensures that learning is driven from the ground up, beginning at the country level and subsequently distilled to inform program-level strategies.

Learnings from MELIA studies will be presented at the Program meetings and shared internally with the Policy Program team. Country-level studies will be presented to country stakeholders, but also aligned to intermediate and overall Program outcomes.

Annual review and adaptive planning

The Policy Program will build on the experience of the 2022-24 Portfolio approach to adaptive management.

Currently, the work plans are being revised following budget revisions . The new adaptive management plans will be developed once greater clarity is reached about the outputs that will be achieved within this year.

5. Reporting

Reporting is a critical process for both internal and external communication, ensuring accountability, transparency, and progress tracking. It facilitates decision-making, supports adaptive management, and communicates Program/Accelerator achievements to stakeholders.

Relevant information from Program Results Frameworks will be integrated into the PRMS Reporting tool from the PRMS ToC Board to facilitate the reporting and evidencing of achievement of both output and outcome indicator targets, as well as links to MELIA studies as sources of evidence.

Further details on Technical Reporting processes, products and support will be shared in 2025.

6. MELIA resources

Please see Annex 3 below.

⁵ MELIA studies to evidence the achievement of Program/Accelerator-level impacts and outcomes (2030 or intermediate) should be entered in the cross-cutting section of the PORB template, shared separately. MELIA studies to evidence the achievement of AoW-level intermediate outcomes that are not covered by any MELIA studies under the cross-cutting section should be entered under the relevant AoW-level outcome in the PORB template.

7. Data management

General approach

The Policy Program is developing a centralized data management system organized by Areas of Work (AoWs) and activities under each High-Level Output (HLO), progressing to encompass cross-cutting activities. This system will integrate key metadata, including the lead researcher for each HLO and the associated CGIAR center, facilitating comprehensive tracking and reporting.

AoW 1 has established a data collection and management system that serves as a model for the entire program. This system utilizes a Power BI interface to present outcome-level data, offering customizable visualizations and real-time updates on key performance indicators. Features include notifications for upcoming deadlines and alerts for unmet targets, enhancing proactive management and accountability.

Data collection methods vary across AoWs, tailored to the specific research approaches employed. For many policy-related studies, secondary data collection is the predominant method. Shared data collected with partners are typically compiled periodically and uploaded annually, while data derived from reports or research use are updated on an annual basis. This structured approach ensures consistency and reliability in data reporting across the program.

Data management in Policy Program will follow the CGIAR Open and FAIR Data Assets Policy.

Annex 2. MELIA Studies

Please refer to **Annex 2.** MELIA studies attachment.

Annex 3. MELIA Budget

MELIA Budget: Staff Cost Breakdown by Year

Activity title	Activity description	Staff (# per type)	Full-time equivalent (# days)	Staff cost (USD)	Inputs <i>i.e. travel costs, special equipment costs</i>	Inputs cost (USD)	Total cost (USD)
Monitoring activities: Cross-cutting							
<i>Activities related to the routine monitoring of HLOs and outcomes</i>							
Inception meeting (incl. TOC review and prioritization)	<i>The workshop gathered leadership, AoW leads and centers to discuss: Prioritization analysis, comparative advantage analysis, partnership arrangements, Updated ToC, MELIA plan. Location Kenya</i>	NA	NA	NA	Logistic costs	10,525	10,525
		NA	NA	NA			
Annual review and adaptive planning	<i>We may organize it virtually in 2025 or F2F in 2026.</i>	NA	NA	NA	NA	0	0
MELIA Focal point	<i>See official TOR for MELIA FP</i>	#, 1	41.25	1,216	NA	0	50,172
MELIA studies: Cross-cutting							
<i>MELIA studies to evidence the achievement of program-level impacts and outcomes</i>							
		NA	0				